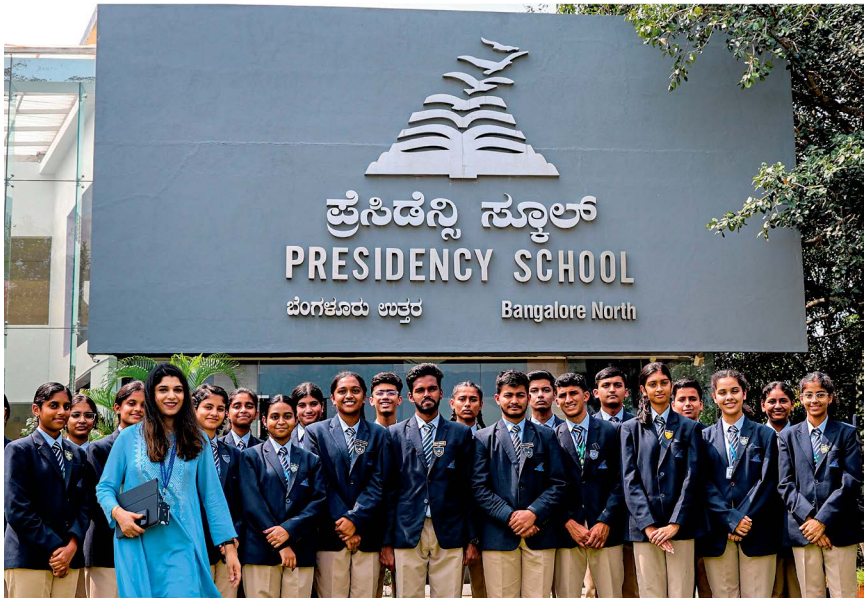








This entrepreneurial mindset also shapes her own leadership. Whether introducing curriculum reforms, investing in sustainable infrastructure, strengthening global collaborations, or integrating emerging technologies, her approach reflects thoughtful risk-taking grounded in long-term vision.

Leading with Empathy

In conversations about leadership, qualities like decisiveness and authority often dominate.

Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed offers a different perspective.

Her leadership is characterised by empathy, collaboration, communication, and inclusion.

She believes that listening is one of a leader's most powerful skills.

Whether interacting with teachers, students, parents, or leadership teams, she actively encourages dialogue, feedback, and shared ownership of decisions.

This people-first approach has cultivated an organisational culture where individuals feel valued, heard, and empowered.

For her, sustainable leadership is never about individual success—it is about enabling collective growth.

Balancing Leadership and Family

Behind every professional milestone lies another equally significant role—that of being a wife, daughter, and mother.

Like countless women balancing multiple responsibilities, Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed understands that leadership does not end when the workday finishes.

Managing a large educational institution while nurturing family relationships requires discipline, resilience, careful prioritisation, and unwavering support from loved ones.

She views work-life balance not as the pursuit of perfection but as the practice of being fully present wherever she is.

Her family remains her greatest source of strength, grounding her amidst the demands of leadership and reminding her of the values that shape every decision she makes.

For young women aspiring to leadership, her journey sends an important message: it is possible to build a meaningful career without losing sight of the relationships and values that matter most.

Recognition That Reflects Impact

Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed's contributions have earned widespread recognition across the education sector.

Among numerous honours, she has received the **Naari Narayani Award,** the **Times Power Women Award,** the **ET Power Icon Award**, and recognition from CIO Times. She was honoured as Education **Leader of the Year** by EducationWorld in 2024, **Education Icon** by Education Today in 2024, and received the **Editor's Choice Award** from Women Entrepreneurs.



While these accolades celebrate her achievements, she considers them reflections of the collective efforts of thousands of educators, staff members, students, and families who form the Presidency community.

Inspiring the Next Generation

As one of India's prominent women leaders in education, Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed believes leadership carries a larger responsibility—to inspire others.

She is passionate about encouraging young women to pursue ambitious goals with confidence, resilience, and authenticity.

Her own journey demonstrates that leadership today is no longer defined by hierarchy or authority. It is defined by purpose, continuous learning, courage, compassion, and the ability to create opportunities for others.

She believes the future belongs to leaders who can combine emotional intelligence with strategic thinking, innovation with ethics, and ambition with service.

A Story Still Being Written

Dr. Nafeesa Ahmed's story is not simply about leading one of India's premier educational groups.

It is about demonstrating how women can transform institutions while remaining deeply connected to their values.

It is about embracing lifelong learning, challenging conventional definitions of leadership, nurturing future generations, and proving that success is most meaningful when it creates opportunities for others.

As she continues to shape the future of the Presidency Group of Institutions, her influence extends far beyond classrooms and campuses. She is helping redefine educational leadership for a new India—one where institutions thrive because people do, where innovation coexists with compassion, and where women lead not by imitation, but by creating their own path.